

THIS IS TECHNOLOGY, CULTURE AND SCIENCE WITH A DIFFERENCE, AND THAT DIFFERENCE IS USUALLY ENOUGH TO MAKE MOST NORMAL PEOPLE GO "WTF?"

ALT this month:

We explore the current situation at the Chernobyl exclusion zone, how news is consumed in India and much more.



Gotham rules

Gotham is a simple, versatile sans serif font designed in the year 2000 for GQ. Over the years, it has been used by many companies, including Coca Cola, Twitter and Netflix. Advertisers love it. Within a short span of time, Gotham has taken over the world and we can see it all around us, in virtual and real spaces. What makes this font so special? <https://dgit.in/gotfont>

The Nuclear Spring at Chernobyl

Between 25 and 26 April 1986, a reactor at the Chernobyl Nuclear Power Plant in Ukraine caught fire. It was the

biggest nuclear power plant fire in history, with the radiation released finding its way all across the northern hemisphere. Over 300,000 people were evacuated from the area. Soon after the disaster, the Chernobyl Exclusion Zone was established. The wildlife in the exclusion zone turned radioactive, with the swallows having mutation rates 2-10 times higher than their cousins outside the exclusion zone. There are also radioactive wolves that spread their mutations to other wolves. However, now flora and fauna in the region are flourishing because of the absence

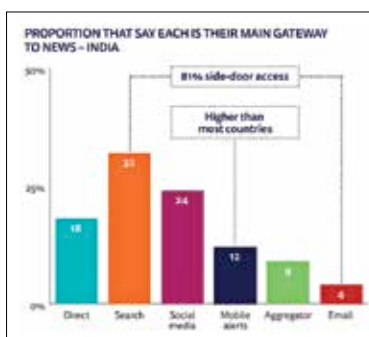


of humans. The populations of elk, deer, bison and wild boar have also shot up. The Chernobyl Exclusion Zone interests researchers as it is one of the few places in the world that humans have withdrawn from.

<https://dgit.in/chspring>

How news is consumed in India

The Reuters Institute and the University of Oxford have investigated the ways in which people in India access online content. Most people use search or social media to get to news articles, with only 18 percent of the readers being loyal to a site, and navigating directly to a particular url of a news site. The biggest social media platforms that people use to get to news articles are Facebook and WhatsApp. 57 percent of the



readers are concerned that the news articles they read contain misinformation, and about 50

per cent are concerned about hyperpartisan news and poor journalism, which is a healthy amount of skepticism. 68 percent of the respondents access news content through their mobile devices. While those over the age of 35 consume more print and television, it is surprising that those under 35 actually listen to more radio.

<https://dgit.in/roind>



The tragedy of airpods

The batteries in airpods last about 18 months. The pods have to be thrown away as recycling them is too much of a hassle considering how tightly the components are packed together. There is no safe way to take apart the airpods, so the batteries cannot even be replaced.

<https://dgit.in/podtrg>



Eating Someone

While scientists know farm animals experience pain or fear, very little is known about their intelligence, personalities and social structures. New research into the private lives of pigs, chickens, cows and sheep show a surprising amount of emotional complexities in them.

<https://dgit.in/eatsheep>



How friends affect habits

The amount of self control and habits that we develop is affected by our friend circle. In an effort to fit in to the group, we may end up eating more, applying less sunscreen, or care less about the environment. We use their behavior as a guide for how to behave ourselves.

<https://dgit.in/frndshab>